SUPERSTRUCTURE AND BELOW DECK

WITH A COMPLEMENT of around 1800 officers and men by 1945, the battleship *Texas* was in some ways like a small town, with its own post office, barber shop, and dentist—although no liquor store, alcohol consumption being officially banned on all US Navy ships, in sharp contrast to the practice of Britain's Royal Navy. This was certainly a large ship, 573 ft (175 m) long and 106 ft (32 m) across the beam, yet there was little room for privacy and precious few frills. Toilet and bathing facilities in particular were quite primitive and most men ate where they slept. It was, however, a well-organized world in which each individual knew his place and his function, and in which the basic needs of health and nutrition were properly addressed.



» Chart House
Located close to the pilothouse and the Captain's sea cabin, this room was used for chart navigation. The devices attached to the wall above the chart table are depth and speed indicators. The bulkheads surrounding the room are made of brass to avoid magnetic interference with compass readings.



» Combat information center
The CIC provided the electronic eyes and ears of the ship, collecting and evaluating information from a variety of sources such as the ship's radar, and coordinating the fire control systems.

» Pilothouse
The ship was steered from the helmsman's station where the ship's wheel, tiller, rudder angle indicator, compass, and engine order telegraph were all located.

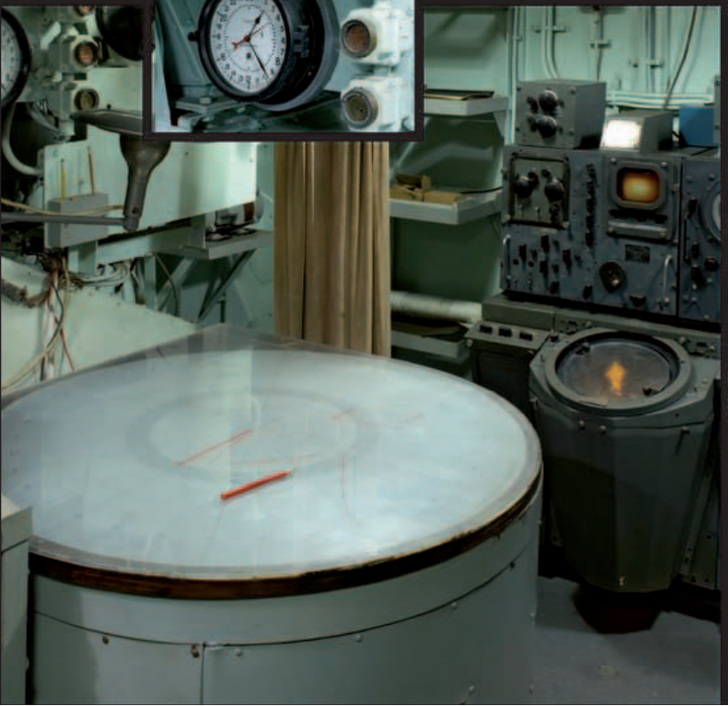


» Navigation dials
The equipment in the auxilliary CIC includes this speed indicator dial and chronometer—a precise timekeeper used to assist in navigation.



» Speaker system
Internal phones and speakers fitted around the *Texas* enabled effective communications between different areas on board the ship.





« Auxilliary Combat Information Center (CIC)
Located in the heart of the ship to provide back-up in case the main CIC was damaged, the auxilliary CIC contained a range of crucial information-gathering equipment such as the surface SG radar unit seen against the wall on the right. The large circular device in the foreground is an illuminated plotting table.



« Executive Officer's Office
The Executive Officer was the second-in-command of the ship. The staff in his office handled much of the ship's day-to-day administration, approved work assignments, and created the daily routine sheet—the orders and schedule for the ship's daily activities.

» Adding machine
The Burroughs machine was an early calculator used to help the officers with their bookkeeping.

